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Scales and Tasks for Art and Creativity Assessment (STAC)

Yoed N. Kenett[1], Paul J. Silvia[2], and Mathias Benedek[3]

[1]Faculty of Data and Decision Sciences, Technion – Israel Institute of Technology, Haifa, Israel
[2]Department of Psychology, University of North Carolina at Greensboro, Greensboro, NC, USA
[3]Department of Psychology, University of Graz, Graz, Austria

Abstract: Over the past few decades, creativity, aesthetics, and the arts have developed as vibrant domains of scientific inquiry. Increasing methodological rigor has led to a proliferation of new methods and measurements, but also to growing heterogeneity in assessments across laboratories. To address this challenge, the open repository *Scales and Tasks of Art and Creativity* (STAC; https://osf.io/4s9p6) was created. STAC provides a curated, open-access archive of measures related to creativity and aesthetics, consolidating authoritative materials, facilitating consistent implementation, and supporting transparent, reproducible research practices across laboratories and disciplines. By lowering practical barriers to measurement while preserving conceptual diversity, STAC supports cumulative progress in research on creativity, aesthetics, and the arts. Since STAC is conceived as a living, evolving repository, we invite contributions from the wider research community to help the archive grow and expand, situating it as a central resource for anyone studying creativity and aesthetics.

Keywords: creativity, aesthetics, arts, assessment, survey, test

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Assessment tools and practices in the psychology of aesthetics, creativity, and the arts have been transformed over the past seven decades. Over time, these domains matured and evolved into distinct assessment traditions of their own that recognized the complex, multifaceted nature of human creativity and the many ways that people engage with and experience the arts. Researchers began to differentiate between divergent thinking, associative processes, creative achievement, aesthetic sensitivity, motivational and affective correlates, and a wide range of beliefs, values, and traits. As conceptualizations expanded, so did the range of available assessment approaches – spanning cognitive performance tasks, expert-rated product evaluations, behavioral inventories, and self-report scales (Clemente, 2023; Kaufman, 2019).

This diversification was accompanied by persistent methodological challenges, such as criterion ambiguity, limited ecological validity, and modest predictive links between tests and real-world criteria (Said-Metwaly et al., 2024). In response, the field has invested heavily in methodological innovation. Recent advances and persisting issues are the center of various special issues (Agnoli & Mastria, 2022; Barbot & Reiter-Palmon, 2019), reviews (Plucker, 2023; Weiss et al., 2024), and initiatives (Kenett et al., 2020). Many advances focused on divergent thinking assessment, such as recent computational approaches that introduced scalable scoring methods using semantic models, graph theory, and AI-based techniques (Benedek & Beaty, 2025; Kenett, 2025). Yet, progress in method development has also led to increasing heterogeneity as researchers adapt tasks, modify instructions, alter scoring procedures, or develop laboratory-specific scales (Elson et al., 2023). Together, this resulted in substantial variation in how measures are administered and scored (Saretzki et al., 2026), raising concerns about reproducibility and cumulative knowledge building.

Thus, the very pluralism that reflects the richness of creativity and arts research has also contributed to fragmentation. Variability in implementation, inconsistent availability of authoritative materials, and dispersed language versions complicate replication efforts and undermine reproducibility. At the same time, open science initiatives increasingly emphasize transparent sharing of research materials as a foundation for robust and cumulative science.

STAC – the open Scales and Tasks of Art and Creativity repository – emerged in response to these developments. It provides a curated, open-access archive of measures designed to consolidate authoritative materials, facilitate consistent implementation, and support transparent,

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reproducible research practices across laboratories and disciplines. Critically, STAC is a living repository – its aim is to expand, grow, and constantly add more tasks and scales to it as the creativity research community advances methodological standardization and research rigor. The aim of this paper is to provide a general overview of STAC and to invite researchers to use it and to help make it grow.

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Aims and Scope

STAC is an online archive (https://osf.io/4s9p6) that hosts scales and tasks for research on the psychology of aesthetics, creativity, and the arts. The primary aim of the archive is to offer a free resource for scholars to find relevant measures that can be readily used in their research. It thereby addresses several goals:

(1) Finding the right measure: Scholars new to the field can gain an overview of state-of-the-art, openly available measures relevant to their work, and experienced researchers may get aware of new developments;
(2) Easy use: Rather than having to extract a scale from a table, appendix, or hidden online supplement of a paper, the archive offers access to measures that can be readily used in research. To this end, many measures come in various formats such as docx, pdf, or survey files that can be easily integrated into a new study;
(3) Consistent implementation: Offering authoritative versions provided by the authors of the measures ensures that the tasks and scales can be used with original instructions and formatting. The archive further hosts all available language versions for measures, so researchers can easily identify whether the measure already exists in their language or a translation may be required. The accompanying readme-file further provides essential information to administration and scoring of the measures. Easy access to authoritative measures in different language versions ensures more consistent use and thereby supports replicability of research and eventually reproducibility of findings;
(4) Increasing visibility: A central benefit of open access is that open works get more attention. What is true for open research papers that get read and cited more often (e.g., Piwowar et al., 2018) likely also applies to openly available tasks and scales.

The accompanying readme-file directs users to appropriate references for each language version to ensure proper credit to the original works.

Development

The archive was initiated and created in 2013 by Paul Silvia at the Open Science Framework (https://osf.io/4s9p6/) under the name "Creativity and Arts Tasks and Scales: Free for Public Use." Mathias Benedek joined in 2018 and Yoed Kenett in 2024 as moderators to help with the increasing number of contributions. In 2024, the archive underwent a major update leading to its current structure. Due to the increasing number of contributions, an additional organizational layer was introduced. Each measure is now filed into a devoted directory that contains all associated files such as document types, language versions, and a readme file for documentation.

Structure

All materials on STAC are centrally hosted and versioned in OSF to support stable access and transparent updates. Users should cite the original instrument source (provided for each entry) and, when appropriate, cite STAC itself as the access point for harmonized administration and scoring materials. We encourage reuse across domains (arts, science, organizational settings, education) and across methodological approaches (behavioral tasks, self-report, computational scoring). STAC is currently organized into three main sections (see Figure 1A; for a detailed list, see supplemental Table SI1 at https://osf.io/a5cps/):

Arts and Aesthetics

The arts and aesthetics section includes measures assessing engagement with, knowledge of, and responsiveness to the arts and aesthetic experiences. The instruments span musical and artistic taste, art interest and knowledge, aesthetic sensitivity and emotional response, and additional aesthetics-related scales.

Creativity

The creativity section includes a *self-report scales* subsection that covers a wide range of constructs such as creative behaviors, activities, and achievements, creative self, humor, and additional relevant scales. A separate *tasks* section includes performance tests related to divergent thinking, associative thinking, humor production, and verbal creative abilities. As the last two decades have seen substantial advancements and proliferation in how especially divergent thinking tasks are administered and scored

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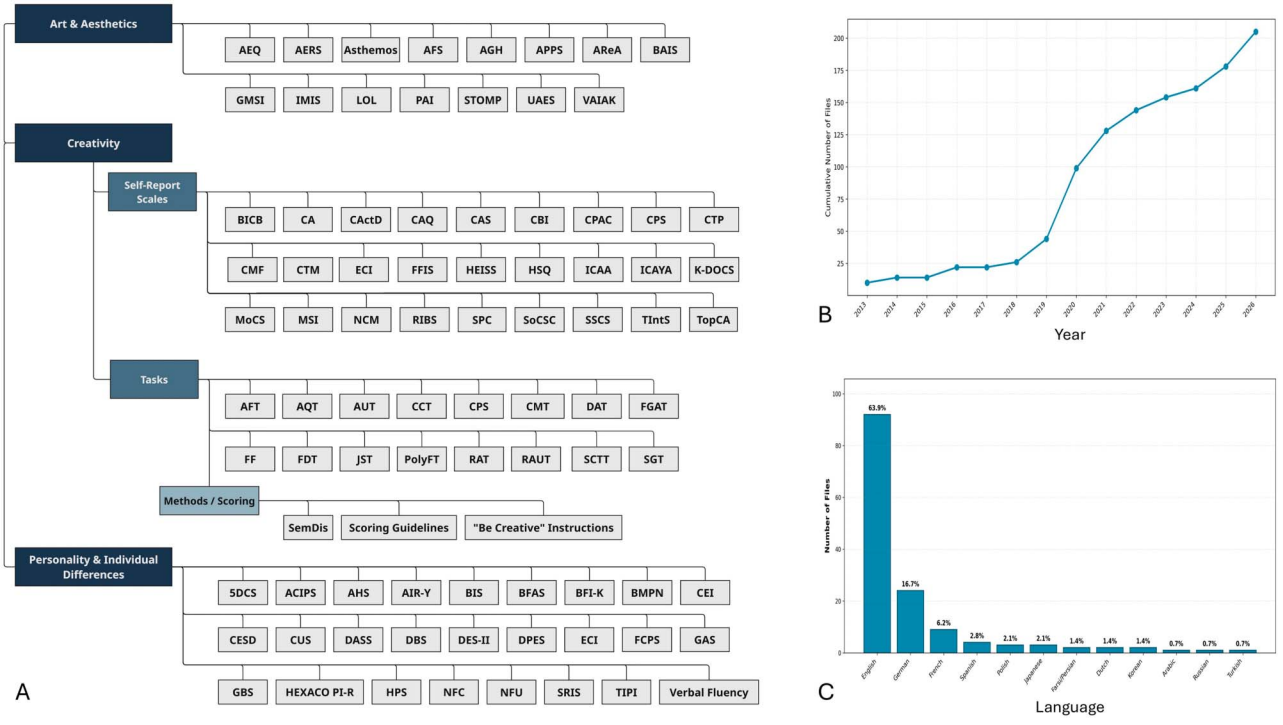


Figure 1. Organization of STAC: (A) STAC structure; (B) cumulative growth in the number of contributions; and (C) distribution of represented languages.

(Saretzki et al., 2026), the tasks section includes a subsection on *methods/scoring* that lists instructions and scoring guidelines for divergent thinking assessments.

Personality and Individual Differences

The personality and individual differences section includes open measures of constructs that do not directly fall into aesthetics or creativity but still are commonly used in this research. It currently includes measures covering personality structure, well-being, affect, stress, and verbal fluency, supporting integrative research that links creativity and aesthetics to mental health, motivation, personality, and social–emotional functioning.

Content

STAC has been proliferating over the years. What started with 10 measures in 2013 has now grown to more than 85 scales and tasks and a total of 205 files (including different language versions but excluding supporting materials such as readmes) in early 2026 (see Figure 1B). The 205 files include mainly pdf (32.2%) and Word (33.2%) documents but also MediaLab (.que) and Qualtrics files (.qsf) that enable direct integration into surveys. Most measures come in English (63.9%) but there are 12 languages represented (including German, French, Spanish, Polish, Farsi, Dutch, Korean, Japanese, Arabic, Russian, and Turkish), indicating that several scales are available in different language versions (see Figure 1C). Together, these measures and materials have been downloaded over 70,000 times, with a large share owing to some especially popular scales as the Kaufman Domains of Creativity Scale (K-DOCS; downloaded over 24,000 times) and the Short Scale of Creative Self (SSCS; downloaded over 16,000 times), followed by the Creative Behavior Inventory (CBI; >9,000), Biographical Inventory of Creative Behaviors (BICB; >8,000), Inventory of Creative Activities and Achievements (ICAA; >5,000), and the Creative Achievement Questionnaire (CAQ; >1,000).

Using STAC

STAC is intended as an archive of relevant scales and tasks as defined above. However, we leave it to individual users to identify which scale or task is most suitable for their specific needs. To facilitate optimal usage of STAC, an overview of all included measures is provided in Figure 1, with descriptive subcategories

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detailed in Table SI1; note that updated versions of Figure 1 are provided in the STAC root directory. After identifying candidate tasks or scales, we encourage users to consult the associated readme files stored together with the measures. These readme files provide brief descriptions of the measures and direct users to key references, such as the original publications. Together, these resources enable users to make informed decisions on which measure to use.

Contributing New Measures

We look forward to seeing STAC grow and welcome submission of new scales, tasks, or language versions that fit STAC's scope. New contributions need to meet the following inclusion criteria:

(1) The measure captures psychological constructs relevant to creativity, aesthetics, or arts at large or captures individual differences in personality or cognitive ability that appear of interest in this context.
(2) The measure was published in a peer-reviewed journal, demonstrating basic evidence of psychometric quality.
(3) The contributors have permission to share the materials openly; typically, they will be authors of the measures and resulting publication, or have developed a translation of it. While there may be other relevant measurements, those that require permission or license to be used are not included.
(4) The contributors provide the measure and clear accompanying information that enable others to use the measure as intended. Specifically, the contributors are asked to provide a readme file in Markdown format (readme.md) giving an overview of the provided files, relevant information on administration and scoring, and information on how to cite the measures (e.g., separate references for each language version). Finally, the readme confirms that the measure is free to use for academic and noncommercial purposes. A template of the readme file and many illustrative examples from the existing measures are provided on the archive.

Anyone who wants to contribute a measure is invited to send all materials to one of STAC moderators (currently, the authors of this article). The moderators will check that the measures fit the inclusion criteria described above and then upload them to the archive.

Discussion

STAC provides a centralized, openly accessible collection of tasks and scales for the assessment of creativity and the arts. By consolidating established instruments alongside emerging measures and providing clear citation guidance, STAC reduces barriers to study design, promotes measurement transparency, and supports cumulative research across disciplines. It offers a free alternative to commercial tests such as APA PsycTests, and it complements existing open test archives such as ZIS by GESIS (https://zis.gesis.org/) and the Open Test Archive by ZPID (https://www.testarchiv.eu/) that focus on German measures in the social sciences.

Creativity and aesthetics research is inherently pluralistic, drawing on diverse theoretical traditions and methodological approaches. STAC is intended to facilitate this diversity while improving comparability across studies, domains, and populations. By making tools easier to discover, implement, and cite, the repository aims to support rigorous and reproducible research on creativity, aesthetic experience, and their role in human functioning.

STAC is intended as a living resource that will continue to evolve alongside theoretical and methodological developments in creativity research. Future updates will incorporate newly developed tasks and scales, additional validated translations, and improved documentation as the field expands. This can only be achieved by active community-based effort. As the number of listed measures grows, a structured organization into more specific thematic subsections within the current three main clusters (aesthetics, creativity, personality/individual differences) may be needed (e.g., creative behavior, creative self-beliefs; see subdomains used in Table SI1 that serve as descriptive bottom-up classification).

We further encourage the inclusion of measures designed to capture dynamic creative processes, collaborative creativity, and domain-specific creative engagement. As computational and AI-assisted methods for creativity assessment continue to develop, STAC will also expand its support for standardized scoring workflows and reproducible analytic pipelines; i.e., the Creativity Assessment Platform (CAP; Patterson et al., 2025), a platform that allows researchers to build, run, and automatically score studies using divergent thinking assessments, and the Open Creativity Scoring with Artificial Intelligence (OCSAI; Organisciak et al., 2023) platform, which allows researchers to automatically score responses to various divergent thinking assessments using powerful fine-tuned language models. By maintaining an open, community-driven structure, it aims to facilitate cumulative research while remaining responsive to emerging questions and approaches.

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Conclusion

STAC aims to consolidate instruments across creativity and the arts into a single, openly accessible resource. In doing so, STAC lowers entry barriers for new researchers, increases measurement transparency, and supports cumulative science. The result is a practical infrastructure that offers an overview of popular open measures on creativity and aesthetics and supports faster study deployment, higher construct coverage, and stronger cross-study comparability, which is relevant to both experts and those entering the field.

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Conflict of Interest
The authors declare no conflict of interest.

Publication Ethics
During the preparation of this work, the authors used ChatGPT for stylistic refinement. After using this tool, the authors reviewed and edited the content as needed and take full responsibility for the content of the publication.

Authorship
Yoed Kenett – original draft, data curation, writing – review & editing; Paul J. Silvia – conceptualization, data curation, writing – review & editing; Mathias Benedek - conceptualization, data curation, original draft, writing – review & editing.
All authors approved the final version of the article.

Open Science
The STAC online repository is available at https://osf.io/4s9p6 (Benedek et al., 2026). It contains all tasks and scales (together with readme documents) described in this article.
Supplemental material is provided at https://osf.io/a5cps/. It contains a full list of all tasks and scales on STAC together with references.

Open Materials: The authors confirm that there is sufficient information for an independent researcher to reproduce all of the reported methodology (Benedek et al., 2026).

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ORCID
Yoed N. Kenett
https://orcid.org/0000-0003-3872-7689
Paul J. Silvia
https://orcid.org/0000-0003-4597-328X
Mathias Benedek
https://orcid.org/0000-0001-6258-4476

Mathias Benedek
Department of Psychology
University of Graz
Universitätsplatz 2
8010 Graz
Austria
mathias.benedek@uni-graz.at

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